

Urge Surfing & HALT

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: Urges rise, peak, and fall like a wave — they always pass, whether or not you act on them. 'Urge surfing' means riding the wave with mindful awareness instead of fighting or giving in. HALT flags four states that make urges stronger.

HALT check — am I...

☐ Hungry

☐ Angry

☐ Lonely

☐ Tired

If any are checked, what can I do to address that need first?

Surf the urge

The urge I'm noticing (substance, behavior, etc.):

Urge intensity at its peak (0 = none, 10 = overpowering):



- Notice where you feel the urge in your body; describe it like a curious observer.
- Breathe with it. Remind yourself: urges peak and pass, usually within 20–30 minutes.
- Don't fight or feed it — just watch the wave rise and fall.

How long did the urge take to ease, and what helped me ride it out?

My plan / supports for next time an urge hits: